ERA 15

The Home Front & the Peace

1917 – 1920

Mobilization · civil liberties · the Great Migration · the League

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did total war reshape American society—and how did the peace fall apart?

KEY TERMS

The CPI · Espionage & Sedition Acts · the Great Migration · the Fourteen Points · the League fight

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 7.6 · AMSCO Ch. 7.6

TOTAL WAR REMAKES AMERICA

The Home Front

Mobilizing the Economy

- The **War Industries Board**, under **Bernard Baruch**, directed war production.
- The government raised billions through **Liberty Bonds**.
- Americans conserved food and fuel through voluntary **rationing**.



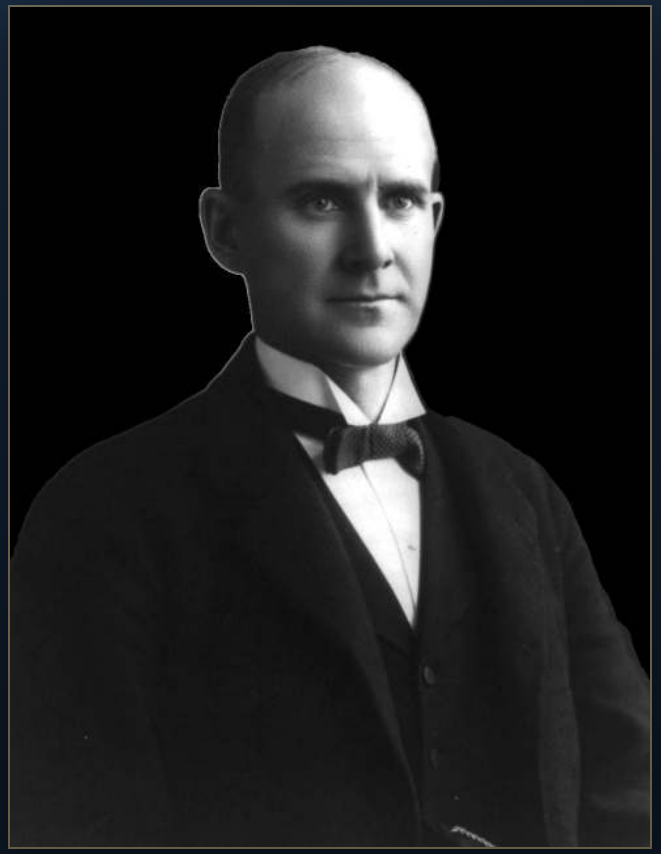
Selling the War



- The **Committee on Public Information**, led by **George Creel**, flooded the nation with **propaganda**.
- Posters, films, and speakers whipped up patriotism.
- Anti-German hysteria followed—sauerkraut became 'liberty cabbage.'

Silencing Dissent

- The **Espionage Act** and **Sedition Act** criminalized anti-war speech.
- In **Schenck v. United States**, the Court allowed limits on speech that posed a '**clear and present danger**.'
- Socialist leader **Eugene Debs** was jailed for an anti-war speech.



SECTION

A Nation Transformed

The Great Migration



- Wartime jobs drew hundreds of thousands of **Black southerners** to northern cities.
- The **369th** '**Harlem Hellfighters**' served with distinction in France.
- But hopes for equality met violence in the **Red Summer** of 1919.

Women and the War

- With men at the front, women filled factories, offices, and war-support roles.
- Their contributions strengthened the case for the vote.
- The **19th Amendment** (1920) granted women's **suffrage**.



SECTION

The Search for Peace

Wilson's Fourteen Points

I

A New Diplomacy

Open agreements, freedom of the seas, and free trade.

II

Self-Determination

Self-determination for peoples and a redrawn map of Europe.

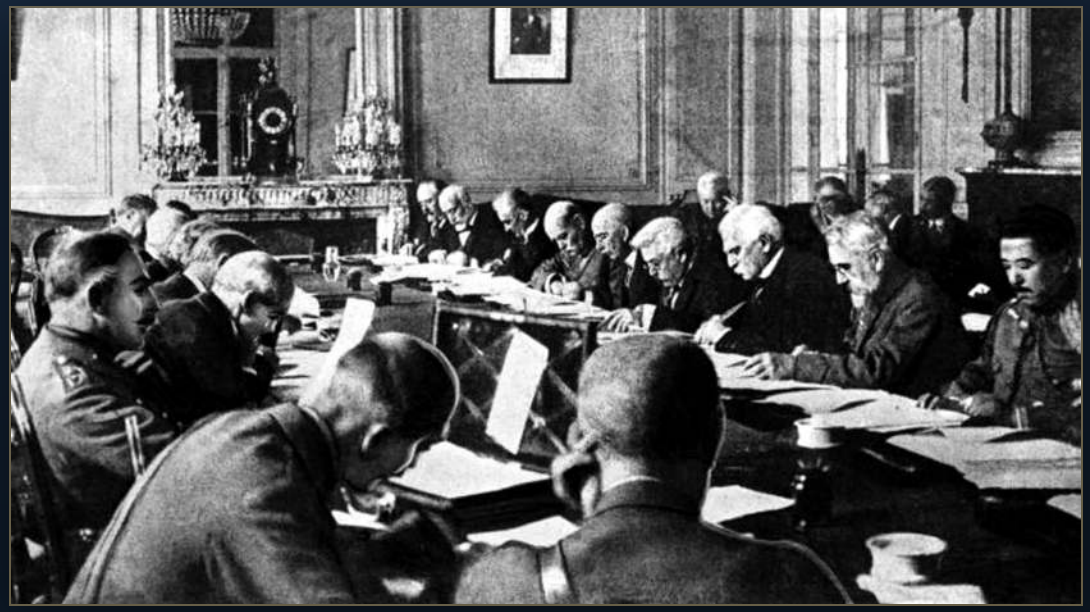
III

The League

A **League of Nations** to keep the peace and prevent future wars.

The Treaty of Versailles

- The Allies imposed a harsh peace—forcing Germany to accept **war guilt** and pay reparations.
- Wilson compromised on his ideals to save the **League of Nations**.
- The bitter terms would help sow the seeds of a second world war.



The Fight Over the League

Wilson & the Democrats

For the Treaty

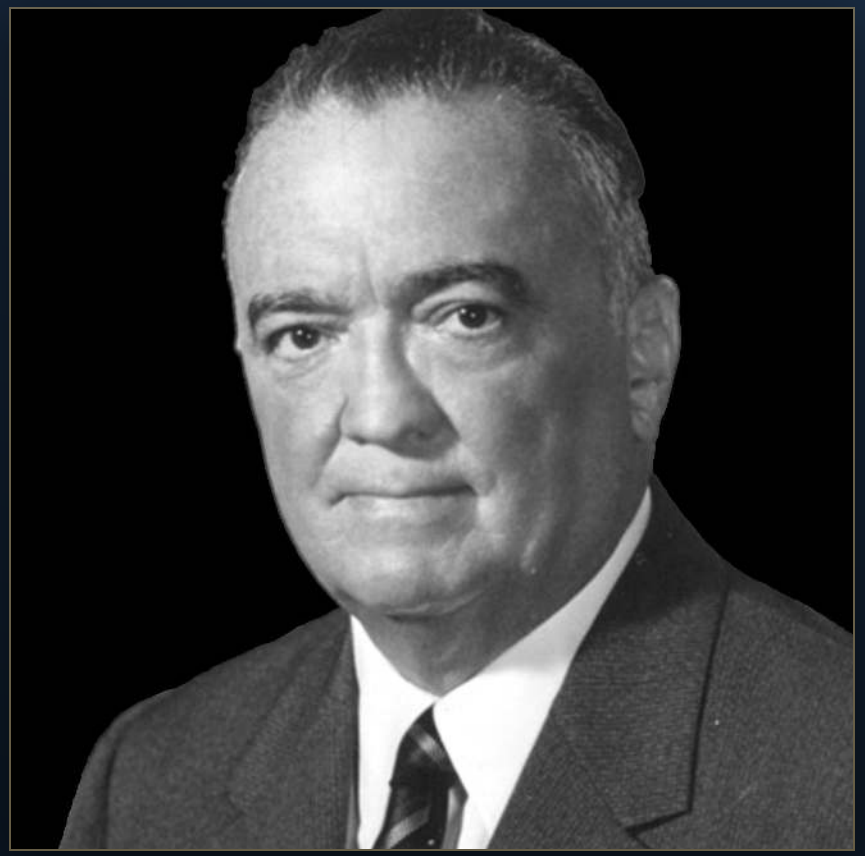
- Believed the **League of Nations** would secure lasting peace.
- Refused to compromise with Senate critics.
- Toured the country until he collapsed from a stroke.

Lodge & the Reservationists

Against (as written)

- Feared the League would drag the U.S. into foreign wars.
- **Henry Cabot Lodge** demanded changes to protect U.S. sovereignty.
- The Senate **rejected** the treaty—America never joined.

The First Red Scare



- Fear of communism and radicalism gripped postwar America.
- The **Palmer Raids** rounded up and deported suspected radicals.
- The **Red Scare** revealed a nation anxious and turning inward.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Home Front & the Peace

1. Total war expanded government power over the **economy** (WIB, **Liberty Bonds**) and **speech** (Espionage & Sedition Acts, *Schenck*).

2. The war spurred the **Great Migration** and women's war work—advancing **women's suffrage** even as Black hopes met the **Red Summer**.

3. Wilson's **Fourteen Points** yielded to a harsh **Treaty of Versailles**, and the Senate's rejection kept the U.S. out of the **League of Nations**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Home Front & the Peace

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the war effort **expanded government power** over the economy and free speech.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the war reshape opportunities for **Black Americans and women**?

ARGUMENTATION

Should the U.S. have joined the **League of Nations**? Make and defend a claim.

Up next — **Lesson 37: The Roaring Twenties** (mass culture & modern America)